

because their mistakes have less of an impact on their quality of life. Some people are able to brush off big errors of judgement with little afterthought because there is no risk to their base level of comfort and security, whereas others can make a small loss and feel floored by it. In other words, 'small' mistakes can feel catastrophic to some people, whereas wasting or losing quite a lot of money can feel quite small to others. This is usually due to external factors, but a key element in reducing shame and forgiving yourself on a deeper level is keeping things in context.

What can we learn from our financial mistakes?

- That we need to deal with underlying issues rather than just the symptoms.
- That it's not possible to out-earn a broken relationship with money.
- That openness about money is a critical part of our relationships.
- That there is power in vulnerability.
- That things aren't always as simple as they seem.
- That there are often other forces at play in our relationship with money.